

Arthritis Exercises for Seniors - Printable Pack

From *Arthritis Exercises for Seniors* by Margaret Hale (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

The 8-Week Tracker

A tick for the morning routine, an A or a B for a strength session, the minutes for a walk (W for the water), the stiffness minutes on Monday, and the worst joint's score out of ten the next morning.

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Stiffness (min)	Next- morning joint (0 to 10)
1									
2									
3									
4									
5									
6									
7									
8									

The Test Sheet

Test	Before Week 1 (date)	After Week 4 (date)	After Week 8 (date)	3 months later
30-second chair stand (number of stands; note "with hands" if used)				
Timed up and go (seconds; note "with stick" if used)				
Stiffness minutes in the morning (average of 3 days)				
Fist: fingertip to palm distance (cm), each hand				
The jar: opened without help? (yes / no)				
Worst joint, out of 10, on an ordinary day				
My normal range for my age (chair stand, from Chapter 4)				

The 30-second chair stand: normal range by age (the middle half of healthy people)

Age	Women (number of stands)	Men (number of stands)
60 to 64	12 to 17	14 to 19
65 to 69	11 to 16	12 to 18
70 to 74	10 to 15	12 to 17
75 to 79	10 to 15	11 to 17
80 to 84	9 to 14	10 to 15
85 to 89	8 to 13	8 to 14
90 to 94	4 to 11	7 to 12

Timed up and go: under 10 seconds is normal; 10 to 12 is fine; over 12 seconds goes with a raised risk of falls, and over 14 a real one (tell the doctor; the balance exercises first).

The Pain and Flare Rule Card

During the exercise	What to do
0 to 2 out of 10	Carry on; when it is easy, do more
3 to 4, an ache in the muscle or a stiffness in the joint	Right; the working level
5 or more, or sharp, stabbing, in the joint	Stop that exercise; the easier version, or leave it out
The next morning	
Same or better than yesterday morning	The session was right
Worse: more pain, swelling or stiffness	The session was too much: halve the dose for a week
A flare (hot, swollen, more painful for days)	Gentle range only for that joint, twice a day; ice or heat; the rest of the body carries on; strength restarts at half the dose when it settles; more than a week, the doctor or the nurse
See a doctor, same day	One hot, red, swollen, very tender joint, with or without fever; a joint that locks or gives way; severe pain after a fall; numbness or weakness in a hand or foot; sudden stiffness of both shoulders and hips with tiredness; a headache with jaw pain or any change in vision

My Precautions

Diagnosis, and the joints involved	
Medicines for the arthritis, and the blood tests due	
Exercises or movements to avoid	
After a joint replacement: the precautions and until when	
Other conditions that matter (bones, heart, blood thinners, diabetes)	
Who to call in a flare, and the number	

The 10-Minute Morning Routine

	Exercise	Dose
1	Make a fist, open wide (warm water if stiff)	10 rounds each hand
2	Thumb to each fingertip	3 rounds each hand
3	Wrist bends and turns	10 each way
4	Chin tuck and nod	5 tucks, 5 nods
5	Neck turns and side bends	5 each way
6	Shoulder rolls and squeezes	10 rolls, 5 squeezes
7	Cat and cow on the chair	10 rounds
8	Ankle pumps and circles	20 pumps, 10 circles
9	Seated hip march and knee straightening	20 marches, 10 each leg
10	Sit to stand	5

Session A (upper body and hands)

	Exercise	Dose
Warm-up	The morning routine, or warm water and shoulder rolls	5 min
1	Soft ball squeeze	10 x 5 s, each hand
2	Finger spread against a band	10 each hand
3	Tabletop bend	10 each hand
4	Thumb stretch and circles	5 circles each way; hold 15 s
5	Arm raises with a stick	10, 2 sets
6	Seated band row	10 to 12, 2 sets
7	Finger walk up the wall	5 walks each arm
8	Doorway chest stretch and outward turn	Hold 20 s twice; 10 turns
9	Wall press-up (forearms if the wrists are sore)	10, 2 sets
Stretch	Wrist stretch, both ways	Hold 20 s, twice each way

Session B (hips, knees and balance)

	Exercise	Dose
Warm-up	The morning routine, or a 5-minute walk	5 min
1	Sit to stand	8 to 12, 2 sets
2	Seated knee straightening	10 to 15 each leg, 2 sets
3	Standing side leg lift	10 each side, 2 sets
4	Standing back leg lift	10 each side, 2 sets
5	Mini squat at the chair	10, 2 sets
6	Step-up on the bottom stair	10 each leg
7	Bridge (on the bed if needed)	10, hold 3 s
8	Heel raises at the chair	15, 2 sets
9	Heel-to-toe stand and single-leg stand	30 s each, 3 times
Stretch	Hamstring stretch and hip flexor stretch	Hold 30 s, twice each

The Flare Routine

	What	How
Morning and evening	The gentle range exercise for that joint only	Slowly, in warm water for the hands and feet; the pendulum for a shoulder; the knee straightening halfway
As needed	Ice (hot, swollen) or heat (stiff, aching)	20 minutes, in a towel
Every day	The morning routine for the other joints; the walk on the flat, shorter, or the pool	As usual
When settled	Strength work for that joint	Restart at half the dose; build over a week
More than a week, or every few weeks	The doctor or the rheumatology nurse	The medicines may need adjusting

The Hands, on a Card

	Exercise	Dose
Warm water first	5 minutes, morning and evening	
1	Make a fist, open wide	10 rounds
2	Tabletop bend	10
3	Thumb to each fingertip	5 rounds
4	Thumb stretch and circles	5 each way; hold 15 s
5	The towel wring	10 each way
Through the day	Soft ball squeeze; the palm not the fingertips; the jar opener, the key turner, the lever tap	